Le discours indirect

Say ou tell ?

- say (that) … : He said that he was late.
- tell + quelqu'un (that) … : He told me that he was late.

On ne dit pas « He said me ».

La concordance des temps

Quand le verbe introducteur est au passé (said, told, asked), on « recule » les temps :

- présent → prétérit : "I am tired." → He said that he was tired.
- prétérit / present perfect → past perfect : "I saw the film." → She said that she had seen the film.
- will → would ; can → could.

Si le verbe introducteur est au présent (says), les temps ne changent pas : Koffi says that he is tired.

Les autres changements

- Pronoms : I → he / she ; my → his / her ; you → I / me selon la situation.
- Temps et lieu : today → that day ; tomorrow → the next day ; yesterday → the day before ; now → then ; here → there.

Les questions

- Question fermée : ask + if : "Are you ready?" → She asked if I was ready.
- Question avec mot interrogatif : on garde le mot, avec l'ordre sujet + verbe : "Where do you live?" → He asked me where I lived.

Les ordres

tell / ask + quelqu'un + to + verbe ; à la forme négative : not to.

"Close the door." → The teacher told us to close the door.

"Don't talk!" → He told them not to talk.

Pièges à éviter

- Pas d'inversion dans une question indirecte : where I lived (et non where did I live).
- Pas de « do / did » dans une question indirecte.

Teste-toi

1. "I will come," he said. → He said that ___.

A. he will came
B. he would come
C. I would come
D. he would came

2. Au discours indirect, « tomorrow » devient :

A. the day before
B. today
C. yesterday
D. the next day

3. "Are you ready?" she asked. → She asked ___.

A. if I was ready
B. if was I ready
C. if ready I was
D. that I was ready

4. Au discours indirect, « here » devient :

A. that
B. there
C. then
D. now

Corrigé

1. B : will → would, suivi de la base verbale.
2. D : Tomorrow → the next day (ou the following day).
3. A : Question fermée : if + sujet + verbe, avec concordance des temps.
4. B : Here → there ; now → then.